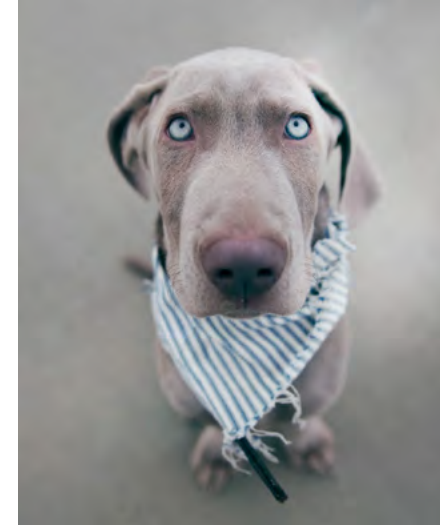


St Adobe Stock

Guide to Mastering Metadata for Adobe Stock

Titles, keywords, and tips for searchability

Updated August 2021



Title and keyword overview

Titles and keywords play a vital role in surfacing your content on Adobe Stock. This guide contains tips, tricks, and examples covering a variety of subjects that can be applied to photographs, illustrations, vectors, and videos. Here are some general tips to get you started:

- Titles should be concise—70 characters is ideal, although the system allows up to 200.
- Titles are searchable and become the URL.
- Include all the important words from the title in the top 10 keywords for an extra “bump” in search relevance.
- Brand names, product names, and people’s names shouldn’t appear in the title. People’s names shouldn’t appear in keywords.
- Keyword order matters, with the first 10 affecting search results the most. [Check out these tips](#) for using titles to create ordered keywords.
- Don’t use uncommon phrases. If it wouldn’t appear in a dictionary, it probably shouldn’t be a keyword. For example, “monkey bars” would be in a dictionary, but “red dress” wouldn’t.
- Nouns should be singular. For example, use “cat” instead of “cats.”
- Adjectives should be descriptive, not subjective. For example, use “red” or “furry” or “sunny” but don’t use “cute” or “sensual” or “beautiful.”
- Simple is better—be descriptive, not verbose. The ideal number of keywords is 15 to 35, but please keep it under 50.
- If you’re aware of additional information such as ethnicity, age, or location, include these specifics in the keywords.

People

People keywords for inclusivity

- **Be transparent.** As your models are signing the release, communicate honestly about how the content may be used and how they'd like to be represented. Discuss the theme of the shoot and the concepts that may be associated with the content to optimize sales.
- **Be considerate.** Think about how you'd like to be described if you were the model. Practices like adding sensationalist, inflammatory, or overly spammy keywords are counterproductive.
- **Be accurate.** Words are powerful, especially when linked with imagery. Titles and keywords should accurately represent the content and shouldn't promote discrimination or perpetuate stereotypes.
- **Be factual.** Keywords related to sensitive personal information like ethnicity, nationality, gender, sexual orientation, age, relationships, and disabilities should be based on fact and supported by the model release or the model's own preferences. Don't assume, guess, or embellish.
- **Be mindful.** Try to avoid cultural appropriation in keywords and titles. Do your homework, especially if you're depicting people, places, or things outside your own culture. It's a good idea to speak to someone you know from a cultural group about the terminology used for representation.

More tips for people keywords

- **Age/gender/ethnicity:** Include a gender (e.g., man or woman), descriptive terms for age (e.g., mature, adult, or teen), and ethnicity/race (e.g., Asian, multiracial, or white). This information should be supported by the model releases provided and/or discussed with your models during the shoot.
- **Sensitive information:** Only include sensitive information such as sexual orientation or disabilities as verified by the model and if relevant to the content. Don't assume, guess, or embellish.
- **Activity:** What are the people doing? Use the root or infinitive form of the verb (e.g., run, jump, cook, or play).
- **Relationship or role:** Describe relationships and/or roles (e.g., father, couple, baker, or farmer). For real people, include the actual relationships or roles. For models, discuss possible roles for the shoot that may be relevant to the content.
- **Facial expressions and appearance:** Use keywords to describe facial expressions (e.g., smile, frown, or looking at camera) and appearance (e.g., blonde, brunette, dreadlocks, or tattoo).
- **Clothing:** Describe clothing if noteworthy (e.g., hat, sunglasses, or roller skates). No need to describe every piece of clothing on every person in the image.
- **Concepts:** Describe concepts demonstrated by the people in the image (e.g., childhood, togetherness, fitness, or healthcare).

Gender/age/ethnicity

For more information please click on either the [gender and age](#), or [ethnicities](#) Wikipedia links
Below are suggestions for representing model's gender, age and ethnicity/race using keywords. These are optional and the lists are non-exhaustive.

1 Gender	Boy	Girl	Man	Woman	Nonbinary	Transgender
2 Age	Adult: Young (20-29) Mid (30-39) Mature (40-64) Senior (65+)		Child: Newborn (0-1) Baby (up to 1) Toddler (1-2) Preschool (2-4) Elementary (5-9)		Teenager: Preteen (10-12) Teen (13-19)	
3 Ethnicity /race	African European	Asian Indigenous	East Asian Multiracial	South Asian Middle Eastern	Southeast Asian Hispanic/Latinx	Black White Caribbean Pacific islander

People

Example: 198330378

Three laughing teen girls in hijabs riding bicycles

girl, teen, adult, young, woman, friend, ride, bicycle, laugh, hijab, piggyback, mixed race, Middle Eastern, Muslim, smile, group, urban, city, Sweden, Europe, bonding, togetherness, three, day, outdoors, lifestyle

Concept: lifestyle



People

Example: 123469331

Portrait of young woman wearing hat and headscarf

woman, adult, young, white, hat, headscarf, portrait, fashion, pattern, lipstick, makeup, model, studio, indoors, day, one, people

Concept: fashion



People

Example: 231947432

Two women in office

woman, Asian, Hispanic, adult, young, muscular dystrophy, wheelchair, multiethnic, disability, diversity, office, work, monitor, computer, colleague, collaborate, desk, indoors, day, two, people, business

Concept: diversity, disability



People

Example: 247627022

Boy and girl playing with wooden blocks

girl, boy, elementary, child, multiethnic, wooden, block, play, black, white, student, toy, brunette, braid, pigtail, build, diversity, education, school, sit, floor, cooperate, learn, indoors, day, two, people, lifestyle

Concept: diversity, education



People

Example: 216056800

Mother and father with newborn

woman, man, adult, mother,
father, newborn, child, white,
brunette, beard, boy, hospital,
family, bonding, birth, care, love,
happiness, togetherness, indoors,
group, three, people, lifestyle

Concept: family



People

Example: 185670931

Girl working at desk in messy room

girl, teen, multiracial, brunette, bun, back, desk, messy, craft, sit, work, create, sew, sewing machine, creative, house, imagination, indoors, day, one, people, hobby, leisure

Concept: craft



People

Example: 133214094

Man helping woman exercise

man, woman, adult, young, multiethnic, exercise, fitness, mat, floor, crunch, help, train, black, white, beard, brunette, natural hair, diversity, indoors, day, two, people, lifestyle

Concept: fitness



Objects

Object keywords

- **Type of Object:** Use the most specific singular noun to identify the object (armchair, bottle, wagon).
- **Object Description:** Use adjectives to describe the object's pattern, color, texture, or condition.
- **No People:** If there are no people, always add No People and Nobody.
- **Arrangement:** How are the objects arranged (row, random, stack, still life)?
- **Setting:** Is it indoors or outdoors? Day or night? What kind of weather?
- **Concepts:** Describe concepts associated with the object (competition, crime, luxury).

Objects

Example: 114265111

Overhead view of handwriting in notebook and camera on table

notebook, handwriting, pen, eyeglasses, camera, table, overhead, still life, chair, journal, travel, indoors, no people, nobody

Concept: still life



Objects

Example: 420645323

Arrangement of colorful geometric blocks

block, geometric, colorful, arrangement, cylinder, rectangle, variety, pastel, group, stack, design, nobody, no people, still life

Concept: still life



Objects

Example: 112668382

Cup and saucer

cup, saucer, teacup, blue, porcelain, table, light, vintage, drink, one, decorative, no people, nobody, indoors, lifestyle

Concept: decorative



Animals



Animal keywords

- **Animal Species:** Be as specific as possible about the type of animal. Include the scientific name, species name, and/or common name (elephant, African elephant, *Loxodonta Africana*). Please be sure to keep the scientific name together as one concept or phrase – do not split into single words or parts.
- **Number of Animals:** Describe the number of animals up to five, use group and animal specific terms (herd, flock, gaggle).
- **Animal Gender:** If male and female gender terms are differentiated within a species, include the gender specific term (ewe, rooster, hen, doe).
- **Animal Age:** If the animal's age is apparent, please add an appropriate descriptive keyword. Use the animal specific word (calf, chick, lamb).

Animals

Example: 158878855

Flamingo standing in water

flamingo, American,
Phoenicopterus ruber, bird,
pink, stand, water, wildlife,
outdoors, night, no people,
nobody, one, animal

Concept: wildlife



Animals

Example: 117122267

Overhead view of Weimaraner dog wearing striped neckerchief

dog, Weimaraner, gray, blue eyes, neckerchief, striped, directly above, pet, canine, canis lupus familiaris, portrait, nobody, no people, animals, one

Concept: pet



Places

Places keywords

- **Geographical Location:** Be as specific as possible about the geographical location (Eiffel Tower, Paris, France). Include location specifics which are verifiable only, through property release information or other trusted sources.
- **Type of Place:** What type of place is it (farm, office, town, cemetery, square)?
- **Location Description:** How would you additionally describe the place (rural, urban, skyline, beach, desert, mountain)?
- **Architectural:** Is it an architectural interior or exterior? Is there a specific architectural element (dome, balcony, door, detail)?
- **Setting:** Is it indoors or outdoors? What is the time of day? Is there a noticeable season or type of climate or weather?

Places

Example: 140642542

Man climbing in the Alps

man, adult, white, climb,
mountain, snow, adventure,
Alps, rock, Chamonix, France,
Europe, helmet, parka, pole,
outdoors, day, one, people, sport

Concept: adventure



Places

Example: 418100325

Aerial view of Vietnamese workers bundling incense sticks

woman, pair, worker, incense, stick, bundle, field, hat, conical hat, Vietnamese, abundance, work, day, outdoors, people, two, obscured, Huyện Ứng Hòa, Hanoi, Vietnam, tradition, culture, aerial view

Concept: aerial view, culture



Places

Example: 196704394

Exterior of apartment buildings with balconies

building, balcony, railing, window, residential, apartment, exterior, architecture, row, old, flag, no people, nobody, outdoors, day, Portugal, Europe

Concept: architecture



Places

Example: 190965015

Modern furniture and pillows

sofa, table, rug, modern,
furniture, pillow, interior, white,
contemporary, couch, white,
leather, plant, minimalist,
simplicity, midcentury,
retro, indoors, no people,
nobody, lifestyle

Concept: interior



Places

Example: 197045838

Scenic view of Mount Saint Helens

mountain, Mount Saint Helens,
fog, valley, volcano, sunrise,
majestic, scenic, nature, tree,
outdoors, Washington, United
States, USA, no people,
nobody, landscape

Concept: landscape



Plants & Flowers



Plants & flowers keywords

- **Type of Plant:** Use the most specific term to describe the plant or flower, including the scientific name (marigold, *Calendula officinalis*). Please be sure to keep the scientific name together as one concept or phrase – do not split into single words or parts.
- **Plant Description:** Use descriptive terms about the plant's appearance (bloom, lush, dewy, spiny).
- **Plant Detail:** Use common terms if you can identify parts of the plant that are prominent in the image (petal, blossom, stem, stalk, leaf, seed).

Plants & flowers

Example: 187947367

Monstera deliciosa leaf

leaf, monstera deliciosa, swiss cheese plant, close up, tropical, green, blue, ceriman, detail, no people, nobody, plant

Concept: plant



Plants & flowers

Example: 260215876

Pink daisy flower with swirling pastel blue ink

flower, daisy, ink, plant, pastel, blue, swirl, composition, surreal, petal, stem, no people, nobody

Concept: flower



Food & drinks



Food & drinks keywords

- **Type of Food:** Use the most specific singular noun to describe the food (pizza, apple, cocktail, tiramisu).
- **Food Description:** Use descriptive terms about the food's color, texture, taste, qualities or cultural significance (green, fresh, savory, organic, Italian, celebration).
- **Cooking Technique:** If known, describe the cooking technique (bake, grill, steam, boil).
- **Conceptual or Trend:** If applicable, use conceptual or trend keywords to describe the food (artisan, healthy, indulgence).
- **Food Related Objects:** Describe any important food related objects (tajine, cutting board, platter).

Food & drink

Example: 224233470

Fried chicken

fried, chicken, savory, meal, plate,
sauce, gravy, pickle, southern,
crispy, indulgence, food, indoors,
no people, nobody

Concept: savory



Food & drink

Example: 247617177

Sliced spice cake

spice cake, cake, slice,
cinnamon, sweet, spicy,
dessert, bundt, bake,
homemade, spice, sprinkle,
dust, nobody, no people,
indoors, food

Concept: sweet



Food & drink

Example: 239094008

Margaritas on ice with salted rim

margarita, drink, cocktail,
tequila, lime, alcohol, beverage,
refreshment, ice, glass, salt,
straw, festive, colorful, indoors,
nobody, no people

Concept: drink



Food & drink

Example: 203309392

Hands with crate of Fuji apples

hand, apple, crate, Fuji, red, fruit, ,
Malus domestica, white, wet,
wood, group, fresh, food, indoors,
people, obscured, lifestyle

Concept: fresh, obscured



Food & drink

Example: 233803824

Overhead view of ingredients for whole grain pancakes

ingredient, wheat, grain, flour,
egg, egg shell, shell, butter, food,
spatula, measuring cup, oats, bowl,
cutting board, wood, preparation,
pancake, overhead, view, indoors,
nobody, no people

Concept: ingredient



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Business & industry

Image Source | 353694236

Business & industry keywords

- **Topical:** Include specifics to the type of business or industry (architect, refinery, manufacturing).
- **Conceptual or Trend:** If applicable, use conceptual or trend keywords to describe the business (creative, artisan, commercial).

Business & industry

Example: 132971505

Man in creative office

man, adult, young, white, woman, brunette, beard, eyeglasses, sofa, laptop, talk, collaborate, multiethnic, office, creative, meeting, brainstorm, people, two, obscured, blurred, indoors, day, business

Concept: business, creative



Business & industry

Example: 256053265

Barber uses a straight razor to shave senior man's face

man, adult, senior, white, barber, shave, straight, razor, groom, luxurious, relax, barbershop, local, business, skill, cosmetology, authentic, indoors, two, people, lifestyle

Concept: local, business



Business & industry

Example: 139140207

Man welding in workshop

man, adult, helmet, welding,
spark, metal, workshop, industrial,
skill, manufacturing, machinery,
safety, indoors, people, one,
business, industry

Concept: industry



Business & industry

Example: 187803199

Offshore oil industry in Angola

oil, Angola, offshore, industry, Africa, ship, water, ocean, rig, production, petroleum, gas, crude, fuel, outdoors, day, sky, no people, nobody, industrial, Western Africa

Concept: industry



Illustration



Illustration keywords

- **Style:** Include keywords that describe the illustration or icon.
 - **Illustrations:** keywords to include are illustration, art, graphic
 - **Vectors:** keywords to include are vector, graphic and if it is an icon, include icon
 - **3D Renderings:** keywords to include are 3d, render, rendering, digital
 - If an art style or medium is represented, include words like watercolor or etching.
- **Main Subject:** Describe the main subject of the illustration (dog, woman, flower).
- **Theme:** Does the illustration have a theme? (Christmas, finance, travel)
- **Supporting Details:** Is anything else in the picture? (bicycle, aardvark, ocean, airplane)
- **Action:** Describe the action, if applicable (run, swim, dance).
- **Setting:** Place or time of day (underwater, Jupiter, night, rainforest).
- No need to include Latin or scientific names on cartoonish illustrated plants and animals, but you can for scientific illustrations.

Illustration

Example: 214613961

Illustration of woman transforming

woman, transformation, colorful, float, surreal, fantasy, abstract, illustration, art, graphic, people

Concept: abstract, people



Illustration

Example: 182380148

Illustration of fox wedding

fox, mouse, hat, veil, wedding, illustration, forest, tree, plant, nature, anthropomorphic, art, graphic, outdoors, day, no people, nobody, animal

Concept: anthropomorphic



Illustration

Example: 307330500

Scientific illustration of ginger root

scientific, illustration, ginger root,
ginger, root, plant, Gingembre
officinal, Zingiber officinale, ink,
black and white,
botanical, art, graphic

Concept: plant



Gingembre officinal (Zingiber officinale).

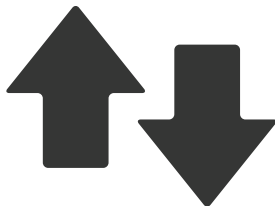
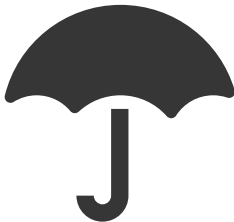
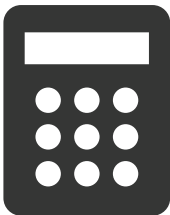
Vector

Example: 93761161

Finance icon set

vector, icon, set, finance,
money, saving, bank, growth,
calculator, scale, chart, laptop,
umbrella, diamond, cash,
arrow, gold bar, safe, gavel

Concept: icon



3D Render

Example: 379953026

Glass and solid spheres

3d render, 3d, render, digital, rendering, glass, sphere, solid, translucent, reflective, shiny, abstract, modern, ornament, shape, ball, clear, blue

Concept: 3d render



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Video

Video keywords

- Overall, titles and keywords for video clips follow the same rules as for still images, with the exception of the following:
- If the clip uses a special technique or camera angle for the shot (zoom, timelapse, aerial), be sure to include it in the title and the keywords.
- Check out the glossary at the end of this section for a list of terms and definitions.

Video

Example: 195169324

Panning shot of spools of thread

panning, spool of thread, sewing, machine, blue, pink, teal, multicolor, thread, spool, four, textile, needlework, craft, variety, pan, industry, indoors, day, no people, nobody, industry

Concept: panning

[Video Link](#)



Video

Example: 88425720

Gray cats moving heads in unison

lockdown, cat, tabby, gray, head, move, unison, humor, jump, play, toy, feline, pet, Felis catus, indoors, group, six, pet, animal, lock shot, no people, nobody

Concept: lockdown

[Video Link](#)



Video

Example: 183529613

Slow motion shot of women taking selfie

slow motion, woman, white, young, adult, sit, smartphone, selfie, smile, photograph, pair, hold, outdoors, day, street, curb, photo, social media, blonde, long hair, people, lifestyle

Concept: slow motion

[Video Link](#)



Video

Example: 193173209

Colleagues talking in conference room

panning, man, woman, white, group, conference, table, talk, laptop, three, chalkboard, office, brunette, short hair, beard, teamwork, pan, business, people

Concept: panning

[Video Link](#)



Video techniques and camera angle keywords

Video technique/ camera angle keyword	Definition	Synonyms	Example Clips
aerial	a shot that's taken from an elevated vantage point than what is framed in the shot	flyover	112869270 , 225306236 , 181307161
alpha	a shot with the subject isolated or clipped/ masked from the background		170399761 , 204942327 , 245774321
arc shot	a shot where the camera spins around the subject - usually on a steadicam		181844359 , 181036434
bokeh	a shot with out-of-focus areas in the background or entire shot		208767820 , 209251710 , 219808526 , 98835505
cinemagraph	still photographs in which a minor and repeated movement occurs, forming a video clip		182501538 , 119816843
close up	a shot taken at close range		138135975 , 240635401
crane	a shot taken by a camera on a moving crane or jib	crane shot, jib, jib shot	201579272 , 185187570
crash zoom	a shot with an extremely fast zoom - usually zooming in		
depth of field	the distance between the nearest and the furthest objects that are in acceptably sharp focus in a shot	dof	261838500 , 139964668 , 190626769

Video techniques and camera angle keywords

Video technique/ camera angle keyword	Definition	Synonyms	Example Clips
dolly	any shot where the camera follows backward, forward or moves alongside the subject being recorded	slider, tracking shot	166057693 , 270832290 , 141736597 , 192497363
dolly zoom	a shot with a zoom in and pull out at same time or vice versa		167047040 , 167047480
Dutch angle	an uneven shot - a viewpoint like tilting one's head to the side		165064799
establishing shot	a shot that sets up, or establishes the context for a scene by showing the relationship between its important figures and objects		178455697 , 233304975 , 228048574
exterior	a shot of the exterior of a structure, a shot taken outdoors/outside, can include outside looking in	EXT	285159057
extreme close up	a shot so tight that only a detail of the subject, such as someone's eyes, can be seen		124380102
extreme long shot	shows entire subject, in relation to surroundings, but from farther away so subjects are indiscernably small		
eye level	shot of a person eye level with camera		137810678
filter	changes the appearance of an image or shot by altering the shades and colors of the pixels in some manner		

Video techniques and camera angle keywords

Video technique/ camera angle keyword	Definition	Synonyms	Example Clips
fisheye	shot by an ultra wide-angle lens that produces strong visual distortion intended to create a wide panoramic or hemispherical image.		143627309 , 66397179 , 84810350 , 66366230
follow shot	a shot taken behind a person/car/animal/subject that follows movement; also a tracking shot, but a specific kind		123118060 , 167517428
gimbal	a shot taken using a camera stabilization device		179035240
handheld	a shot where a camera is held in the camera operator's hands as opposed to being mounted on a tripod or other base		243422382 , 159802626
high angle	where the subject is shot from a raised viewpoint, though not from high in the air		169414763
interior	a shot taken indoors, inside a built structure, includes inside looking out	INT	302968408
lock down	stationary shot	lock shot	138911450
long shot	shows entire subject, in relation to surroundings		216715728
loop	a shot that repeats		194727592 , 225740773

Video techniques and camera angle keywords

Video technique/ camera angle keyword	Definition	Synonyms	Example Clips
low angle	where the subject is shot from beneath the subject	up shot	103303900, 49493635
macro	extreme close-up shot, usually of very small subjects and living organisms like insects, in which the size of the subject is greater than life size		164116767, 101434226
medium shot	frames the subject from the waist up		222234166, 228244831
medium wide shot	shows a character cut off just above or below the knees, wide enough to show the setting, but close enough to show facial expressions		190464144, 227365065
one shot	a shot featuring one person	single shot	100047466, 248624360
over the shoulder	reverse shot when two people are facing each other, like in an interview; or looking over one's shoulder to reveal something		118654403, 142613358
panning	a shot taken by swivelling a video camera horizontally from a fixed position	pan	135187533
pan left	a shot taken by swivelling a video camera horizontally to the left from a fixed position	panning	135187533
pan right	a shot taken by swivelling a video camera horizontally to the right from a fixed position	panning	246298982

Video techniques and camera angle keywords

Video technique/ camera angle keyword	Definition	Synonyms	Example Clips
point of view	a shot that shows what the subject is seeing from their perspective	POV	191705095 , 223431064 , 105068884
pull back	a tracking shot or zoom that moves back from the subject to reveal the context of the scene		270832290
pull out	a tracking shot or zoom that moves out from the subject to reveal the context of the scene	pull-out	270832290
push	a tracking shot or zoom that moves in towards the subject to reveal the context of the scene	push in	141736597
rack focus	changing the focus of the lens during a shot		58292326 , 192072476 , 124192850
real time	a shot that shows the subject in actual time		219225198 , 179278100
shaky	a cinematographic technique where stable-image techniques are purposely dispensed with to show shaking		171478980
shallow depth of field	a shot that deliberately blurs out details in either the background or foreground of the scene, to draw the viewer's attention to one particular subject	shallow depth-of-field, shallow dof	139964668
slider	any shot where the camera follows backward, forward or moves alongside the subject being recorded	dolly, tracking shot	166057693 , 270832290 , 141736597 , 192497363 ,

Video techniques and camera angle keywords

Video technique/ camera angle keyword	Definition	Synonyms	Example Clips
slow motion	a shot where time appears to be slowed down		249083908 , 189235819 , 267762731 , 84807796 , 208927136
steadicam	shot using a stabilization device		162593164
still	a shot that features a single captured frame		
three shot	a shot featuring three people		101411979
tilt	a shot where the camera tilts, rotating around the axis that runs from left to right through the camera head		121157913
tilt down	a shot where the camera tilts down		261154697
tilt shift	a shot using camera movements that change the orientation and/or position of the lens with respect to the film or image sensor on cameras		86975269 , 181567391 , 181581200 , 66366230 , 116903238
tilt up	a shot where the camera tilts up		213723545
timelapse	shooting a sequence of frames at set intervals to record changes that take place slowly over time		115387018 , 273326762 , 91475019 , 123405887 , 235402983

Video techniques and camera angle keywords

Video technique/ camera angle keyword	Definition	Synonyms	Example Clips
tracking shot	any shot where the camera follows backward, forward or moves alongside the subject being recorded	dolly, slider	192497363 , 120104197 , 166057693 , 124197346
two shot	a shot featuring two people		195087131
ultra wide shot	same as extreme long shot		
wide shot	similar to long shot, shows entire scene or setting		216715728
zoom	the technique of changing the focal length of a zoom lens, and hence the angle of view, during a shot		211207720
zoom in	the technique of changing the focal length of a zoom lens into the shot		14209042
zoom out	the technique of changing the focal length of a zoom lens out of the shot		171343113 , 92065255

Additional resources

- [*Adobe Stock Artist Hub*](#)
- [*Adobe Stock Discord Community*](#)
- [*Metadata Quick Tips: Titles and Keywords*](#)



